**26900280** **Reg.No : .....**

**Name : .....**

# MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

## MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours) REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026

## Fifth SEMESTER

## Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG5DSEHIS300 - GENDER AND INDIAN HISTORY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

**Duration: 2 hours** **Maximum Marks: 70**

***Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)***

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

### Part A

Short Answer Questions

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. Write a short note on women's dissatisfaction in post-war America [U] / [CO1]
2. How did women contribute to cultural and intellectual life in medieval courts? [An] / [CO2]
3. National Council of Indian Women [K] / [CO4]
4. What is Caste Endogamy? [K] / [CO5]
5. What was the role of women in Sufi religious spaces? [E] / [CO2]
6. What is meant by gender expressions? [K] / [CO1]
7. What is the cult of domesticity? [U] / [CO2]
8. Kasturba Gandhi [K] / [CO4]
9. What is meant by femininity? [K] / [CO1]

10. What is Gendered Time Poverty? [U] / [CO5]

11. What do you mean by Comodification of the Womb? [K] / [CO5]

12. What was purdah or female seclusion in medieval Muslim society? [U] / [CO2]

**[2x10 = 20]**

## Part B

Short Essay Questions

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

13. Discuss the relationship between gender identity and social expectations [An] / [CO1]

14. Distinguish between normative ideals and actual gender relations. [An] / [CO2]

15. Analyse the construction of the 'ideal Indian woman' in nationalist discourse [An] / [CO3]

16. How do caste, class, and gender interact to shape social hierarchy and inequality among women in post-colonial India? [An] / [CO4]

17. Discuss the contribution of Joan Scott to the development of gender history [E] / [CO1]

18. Discuss the significance of women's voices in challenging conventional knowledge [U] / [CO1]

19. Explain how marriage functioned as a means of establishing the patriarchal household (grha) in the early Grhyasutras [E] / [CO2]

20. Trace the emergence of new ideals of masculinity and femininity in colonial period [U] / [CO3]

21. Why is an intersectional approach necessary for understanding women's experiences? [An] / [CO1]

22. Analyse what the reference to Sutanuka and Devadatta reveals about the personal and social world of devadasis. [An] / [CO2]

**[5x6 = 30]**

## Part C

Essay Questions

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **10** marks

23. “Genius cannot flourish in the absence of social and material freedom”. Discuss this idea with reference to Virginia Woolf's "A Room of One's Own". [E] / [CO1]

24. The heterodox sects created new spaces for women, but did not completely free them from patriarchal structures. Analyse this statement with special reference to Buddhism and Jainism. [An] / [CO2]

25. Assess the contribution of women professionals to the wider process of social transformation during the British period [E] / [CO3]

26. Evaluate the efficacy of state interventions like the PCPNDT Act and Beti Bachao Beti Padhao in countering deeply entrenched religious fundamentalism and son preference. [U] / [CO4]

**[10x2 = 20]**